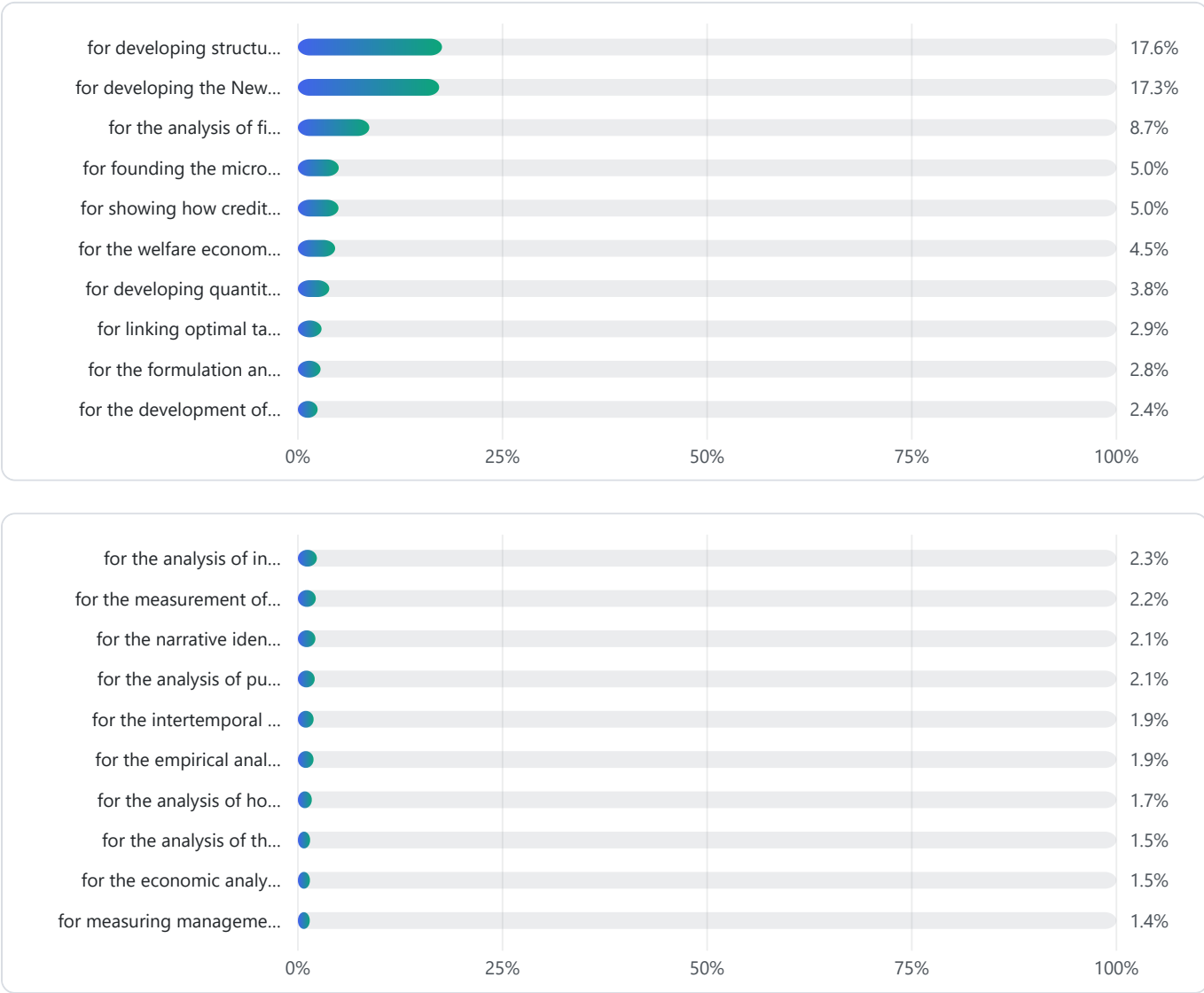


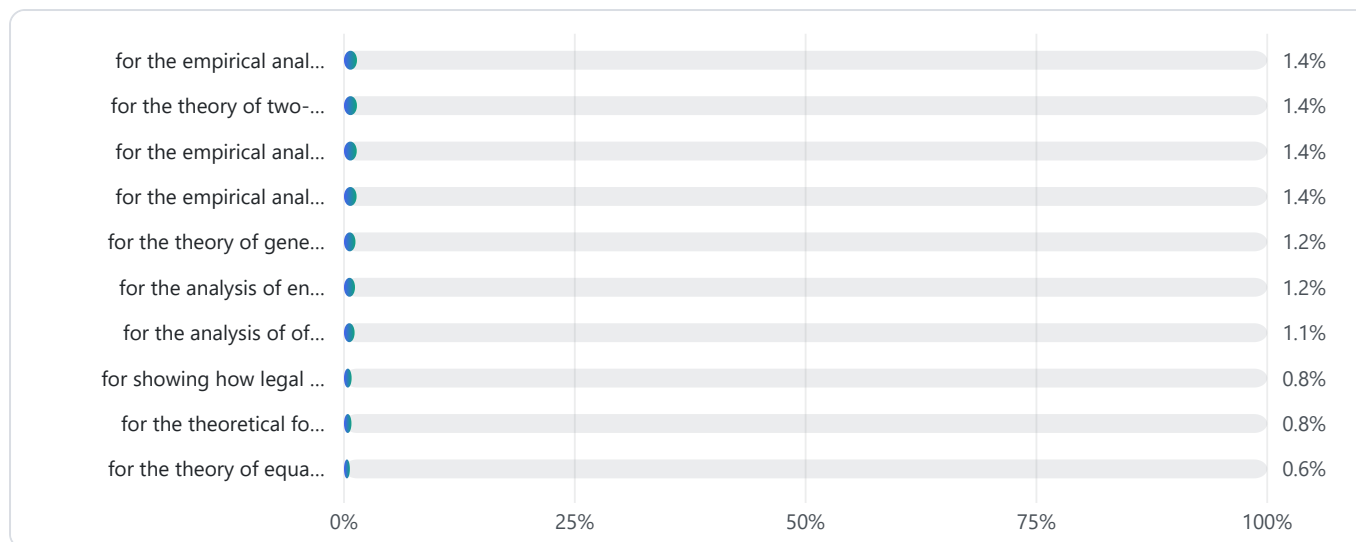


Which contribution will the 2026 Nobel Prize in Economic Sciences be awarded for?

Generated 2026년 10월 10일 오후 3:36

Forecast distribution





Full option labels

1. for developing structural methods for the empirical analysis of demand and market power in differentiated-product markets — Steven Berry, James Levinsohn, Ariel Pakes (Production, Industrial Organization)
2. for developing the New Keynesian framework of nominal rigidities and welfare-based monetary policy analysis — Michael Woodford, Jordi Galí, Mark Gertler (Macro)
3. for the analysis of firm heterogeneity, selection and reallocation in international trade — Marc J. Melitz, Andrew B. Bernard, Elhanan Helpman (Trade)
4. for founding the micro-founded intertemporal new open-economy macroeconomics — Maurice Obstfeld, Kenneth Rogoff (Trade)
5. for showing how credit constraints and collateral amplify and propagate macroeconomic fluctuations — Nobuhiro Kiyotaki, John Moore (Macro)
6. for the welfare economics of sustainability, natural capital and intergenerational wealth accounting — Partha Dasgupta, Geoffrey Heal (Equilibrium, Welfare)
7. for developing quantitative Ricardian general-equilibrium models of trade, technology and geography — Samuel Kortum (Trade)
8. for linking optimal tax and social insurance theory to empirically estimable sufficient statistics — Emmanuel Saez, Raj Chetty, Henrik Kleven (Public, Law, Political Economy)
9. for the formulation and analysis of rules for monetary policy and of staggered contracts — John B. Taylor (Macro)
10. for the development of heterogeneous-agent incomplete-markets macroeconomics and methods for solving it with aggregate shocks — Mark Huggett, Anthony A. Smith Jr., Truman Bewley (Macro)
11. for the analysis of innovation, growth and the political economy of trade policy — Gene M. Grossman, Elhanan Helpman (Trade)
12. for the measurement of top incomes and wealth from tax records and its integration into the theory of optimal taxation — Emmanuel Saez, Thomas Piketty, Gabriel Zucman (Public, Law, Political Economy)
13. for the narrative identification of the macroeconomic effects of monetary and fiscal policy — Christina D. Romer, David H. Romer, Valerie A. Ramey (Macro)

14. for the analysis of public debt, Ricardian equivalence and tax smoothing in intertemporal macroeconomics — Robert J. Barro (Macro)
15. for the intertemporal analysis of consumption under rational expectations and of labor-market fluctuations — Robert E. Hall (Macro)
16. for the empirical analysis of health insurance and social insurance design — Amy Finkelstein, Jonathan Gruber, Raj Chetty (Public, Law, Political Economy)
17. for the analysis of how political institutions and constitutions shape economic and fiscal policy — Torsten Persson, Guido Tabellini (Public, Law, Political Economy)
18. for the analysis of the structure, regularity and limits of general equilibrium theory — Andreu Mas-Colell, Yves Balasko (Equilibrium, Welfare)
19. for the economic analysis of law, liability and enforcement — Steven Shavell, Richard A. Posner, Guido Calabresi (Public, Law, Political Economy)
20. for measuring management practices and their effects on productivity across firms and countries — Nicholas Bloom, John Van Reenen, Raffaella Sadun (Production, Industrial Organization)
21. for the empirical analysis of entry and competition in concentrated markets — Timothy F. Bresnahan, Peter C. Reiss (Production, Industrial Organization)
22. for the theory of two-sided markets and platform competition — Jean-Charles Rochet, Mark Armstrong, Bruno Jullien (Production, Industrial Organization)
23. for the empirical analysis of the local labor-market effects of import competition — David H. Autor, David Dorn, Gordon H. Hanson (Trade)
24. for the empirical analysis of productivity dispersion, firm dynamics and reallocation using microdata — John C. Haltiwanger, Lucia Foster, Chad Syverson (Production, Industrial Organization)
25. for the theory of general equilibrium with incomplete markets and its constrained inefficiency — John Geanakoplos, Herakles Polemarchakis, Michael Magill (Equilibrium, Welfare)
26. for the analysis of endogenous sunk costs and the bounds approach to market structure — John Sutton (Production, Industrial Organization)
27. for the analysis of offshoring, incomplete contracts and the organization of global value chains — Pol Antràs, Gene M. Grossman, Esteban Rossi-Hansberg (Trade)
28. for showing how legal origins and investor protection shape financial and economic development — Andrei Shleifer, Rafael La Porta, Florencio Lopez-de-Silanes (Public, Law, Political Economy)
29. for the theoretical foundation of structural gravity and the measurement of trade costs — James E. Anderson, Eric van Wincoop (Trade)
30. for the theory of equality of opportunity, responsibility and fairness in welfare economics — John E. Roemer, Marc Fleurbaey, François Maniquet (Equilibrium, Welfare)

TL;DR

BLP demand and market-power estimation leads my forecast at 18%, followed by New Keynesian monetary-policy foundations at 17% (BLP recognition; monetary-policy recognition). Firm heterogeneity in international trade ranks third at 9% (Melitz recognition). These

probabilities are conditional on a listed contribution matching the official motivation, not on the named people forming the exact laureate combination.

Context

The information cutoff is October 10, 2026, at 20:27 UTC. The announcement is scheduled for October 12 at 11:45 CEST at the earliest, or 09:45 UTC, leaving 37 hours and 18 minutes before the earliest announcement (official schedule). (nobelprize.org)

This is uncertainty about an institutional choice, not about discoveries made before Monday. I assign probability to contributions first, then consider which recipient combinations and official wording could support them. Unlisted outcomes are excluded by the question’s condition; they are not redistributed according to the number of options in each field.

Evidence

The historical backbone is small: 57 economics prizes went to 99 laureates from 1969 through 2025. That supports broad reference classes, not a reliable statistical fit for this particular contribution menu (official historical record). Nominations remain confidential for 50 years, so public candidate lists are not verified shortlists (nomination rules). (nobelprize.org)

The Nemmers Prize provides a useful recognition reference class. Among its 16 economics recipients from 1994 through 2024, ten received the Nobel by the end of 2025: 62.5%. Among those ten conversions, the delay ranged from the same year to 16 years, with a median of seven years. These are calculations from the complete recipient history below, checked against Nobel outcomes through 2025—not next-year success probabilities (Northwestern history; Nobel history). Recent recipients have had much less follow-up time. (economics.northwestern.edu)

Nemmers year	Recipient and Nobel outcome through 2025
1994	Peter Diamond — 2010
1996	Thomas Sargent — 2011
1998	Robert Aumann — 2005
2000	Daniel McFadden — 2000
2002	Edward Prescott — 2004
2004	Ariel Rubinstein — none
2006	Lars Peter Hansen — 2013
2008	Paul Milgrom — 2020
2010	Elhanan Helpman — none

Nemmers year	Recipient and Nobel outcome through 2025
2012	Daron Acemoglu — 2024
2014	Jean Tirole — 2014
2016	Richard Blundell — none
2018	David Kreps — none
2020	Claudia Goldin — 2023
2022	Ariel Pakes — none
2024	Michael Woodford — none
2026	Whitney Newey — outside the historical comparison cohort

New Keynesian monetary economics has the strongest recent recognition.

Woodford’s 2024 Nemmers citation explicitly recognizes New Keynesian general-equilibrium analysis and the connection between monetary theory and practice. BBVA’s award announced February 25, 2025 recognized Blanchard, Galí and Woodford for the same research program. Clarivate added Woodford on September 17, 2026 for monetary-policy theory and practice (Nemmers citation; BBVA announcement; Clarivate announcement). I treat these as overlapping recognition of scholarly standing, not three independent signals about the Nobel decision. Clarivate itself disclaims prediction of a particular year’s recipients. (nemmers.northwestern.edu)

BLP has the clearest contribution-specific recognition. Clarivate’s September 23, 2020 announcement names Berry, Levinsohn and Pakes specifically for their random-coefficients demand-estimation model. Pakes’s 2022 Nemmers adds broader empirical-IO recognition (Clarivate citation; Nemmers citation). But the BBVA award announced February 20, 2018 went to Bresnahan, Pakes and Porter for empirical industrial organization broadly—not to the BLP trio. I therefore reserve probability for entry and competition rather than assigning every empirical-IO signal to BLP (BBVA release). (ir.clarivate.com)

Trade has several distinct routes. Melitz’s 2023 Onassis Prize supports the maturity of the heterogeneous-firm contribution (Harvard announcement, October 11, 2023). Quantitative Ricardian trade also has matched recognition: Eaton and Kortum shared the 2004 Frisch Medal and 2018 Onassis Prize (Yale-hosted biographical record). Separately, the Academy lists a 2026 symposium on exchange rates and international capital markets, and international trade in 2027. I read the former as a modest positive for Obstfeld–Rogoff, not a candidate-specific timing signal; the published register supplies no participant program establishing that connection (Academy register). (economics.harvard.edu)

Recent awards create proximity penalties, not exclusions. The 2022 banking and financial-crisis prize is adjacent to collateral-driven credit cycles; the 2024 institutions prize is adjacent to

political institutions and legal origins; and the 2025 innovation-growth prize is adjacent to Grossman–Helpman’s growth work (2022 motivation; 2024 motivation; 2025 motivations). A growth prize does not rule out monetary economics or Barro’s fiscal contribution. Kiyotaki–Moore also retains direct recognition for amplification through financial imperfections (BBVA announcement, March 4, 2021).

Public economics and welfare remain credible alternatives. Saez’s 2009 Clark citation directly supports connecting optimal taxation to measurable parameters, while Finkelstein’s 2012 citation supports empirical insurance analysis (Saez citation; Finkelstein citation). Dasgupta’s BBVA recognition announced February 28, 2024 directly supports natural capital, green accounting and sustainability. That makes sustainability my leading welfare option (BBVA announcement).

For the calculation, I used subjective conditional field priors of 32.0% for macro, 24% each for trade and industrial organization, 12% for public/law/political economy, and 8% for equilibrium/welfare. Within fields, I assessed maturity, contribution boundaries and award readiness. Evidence adjustments were deliberately modest: the largest upward weights went to New Keynesian monetary economics and BLP; neighboring prizes received small discounts. These are judgment inputs, not estimated historical frequencies.

The independent evidence model was mixed back toward its baseline to limit overconfidence, then given 80% weight in the final estimate. The remaining 20% came from an equal-weight pool of the retained contribution-level assessments. I excluded the heavily market/poll-led numerical estimate from that pool and did not transfer its candidate-market percentages into contribution probabilities. The calculation is:

$$p_i = 0.80 \left(0.85 \frac{b_i m_i}{\sum_j b_j m_j} + 0.15 b_i \right) + 0.20 r_i.$$

Here, b_i is the conditional baseline, m_i the judgmental evidence adjustment, and r_i the pooled assessment. The numerical field totals are approximately 33.5% macro, 24% industrial organization, 23% trade, 11% public/law/political economy, and 8% equilibrium/welfare. Decimal rounding was reconciled so the JSON probabilities sum exactly to one.

What's non-obvious

Friberg’s committee appointment is not a clean BLP signal. His March 2026 CV dates service to 2025 and lists industrial organization and trade; the official roster identifies him as co-opted (CV; committee roster). His research also includes an April 2026 paper on menu costs and nominal price adjustment with committee chair John Hassler (institutional publication

record). Moreover, a recent field-rotation paper codes Friberg as a labor economist, contrary to his own CV. That discrepancy prevents me from treating its committee-based model outputs as calibrated probabilities (paper, Appendix A).

Contribution matching removes several weak exclusions. An award to Blanchard, Galí and Woodford could match the New Keynesian option despite the listed names differing (matched recognition). Eaton's death on February 9, 2024 changes recipient availability, not whether Kortum can be recognized for their joint contribution (Yale-hosted obituary). Likewise, Krusell's role as secretary creates an attribution and process question for heterogeneous-agent macroeconomics, because he coauthored the aggregate-shocks method with Smith; it does not establish exclusion of the entire contribution (committee roster; original paper).

Uncertainties

The largest gap is the confidential shortlist and the committee's intended motivation. A broad monetary-policy or empirical-IO award could cross option boundaries, and a divided award would make the question's share and ordering rules decisive. The narrow numerical lead of BLP over New Keynesian economics is not a strong ranking advantage.

I could not verify a candidate-specific symposium program or recusal arrangement. Those would sharpen the international-macro and heterogeneous-agent assessments; their absence from the retrieved record is not negative evidence. Finally, an October 10 interview reports that recommendations are often settled by June, which makes late publicity a weak timing signal (committee-process reporting). The six-decimal probabilities preserve the calculation, not six-decimal knowledge of the committee's choice.

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Question Details

The 2026 Sveriges Riksbank Prize in Economic Sciences in Memory of Alfred Nobel is scheduled to be announced on Monday 12 October 2026, 11:45 CEST at the earliest. Each option names a contribution, in the style of an official motivation, the people most closely associated with it, and its field of economics. The forecast is conditional on the prize going to one of the listed contributions; there is no "Other" option.

Resolution Criteria

Resolves to the option whose contribution matches the contribution recognized by the official motivation of the 2026 Nobel Prize in Economic Sciences, as published at nobelprize.org. Options are matched by contribution; the people named in an option need not match the laureates exactly. If the prize is divided between two contributions, the contribution with the larger share counts; if the shares are equal, the contribution named first in the announcement counts. If more than one option matches, the option whose people include the most laureates counts, then the option that names the recognized contribution most specifically. If no option matches, the question is annulled (the forecast is conditional on one of the listed contributions).